

Abstract for Take-Home Assignment

Course: Social Issues in Information Society

Academic Year: 2025–2026

Project Title:

The Morphology of Uncertainty: Power and Control in the Digital Age

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Objectives

According to Professor Luciano Floridi, “*Whoever controls uncertainty controls society*”. Building on this premise, this project aims to investigate the morphology of uncertainty in the Digital Age. It seeks to identify the actors and mechanisms through which uncertainty is produced, managed, and transformed into a tool of governance and influence using data and algorithms, particularly by major digital platforms. Ultimately, the objective is to highlight who controls society today and how such control over uncertainty constitutes a new and perhaps ultimate form of power.

Contents

The project takes as its starting point the video “*Who Controls Society Today?*” by Floridi, produced as part of the Orbits series on philosophy and digital society. It first explores the concept of power in the Digital Age and its historical evolution. Then, it investigates how uncertainty has become a defining feature of contemporary power, examining how major digital actors transform it into an asset through data-driven infrastructures and algorithmic control. Finally, as the concentration of digital power raises the risk of oligopolistic structures, with significant implications for social and political dynamics, the project discusses possible future scenarios and regulatory approaches, focusing on accountability, antitrust, and digital sovereignty.

Methodologies

This project combines three complementary research approaches. It begins with an interpretative analysis of Luciano Floridi’s concept of the morphology of uncertainty, which provides the conceptual foundation for the study. This is followed by a desk-based literature review aimed at deepening the theoretical understanding of power, control, and information in the Digital Age; and a qualitative case study analysis based on secondary materials to examine how major digital platforms manage uncertainty as a resource and exercise informational power.